

TC-02 · Decision Record

The four key decisions

#	Decision	Answer
D1	Spoken English scoring scale	CEFR A1–C2 — a genuinely different ScoringStrategy , which is what makes Exam 2 a real test of the abstraction rather than a re-run of IELTS
D2	Spoken English packaging	Separate paid module — institute_exam_subscriptions carries per-exam billing hooks from day one
D3	The commercial driver	Revenue evidence by a date , not OET by a date — sequencing is ours to optimise; Spoken English first
D4	Question Bank licensing boundary	Questions + difficulty metadata licensable; performance data and calibration model never

Part 1 — The OET 17, resolved

A · Business Model & Pricing

#	Question	Answer
1	Single vs per-exam subscription	Per-exam modules on a platform base. Follows D2. Billing hooks in schema from day one.
2	OET priced same as IELTS or premium?	Pricing is per-module , so OET can carry a premium with zero code change. Paywall CTA reads billing_status and is exam-generic.

- 3 OET B2B or also B2C **B2B first.** `selfRegistration` flag exists per exam; ship it `false` for OET, keep it flip-capable. Build the flag, not the screen.

B · Brand & Domain

#	Question	Answer
4	Own domain or in-app mode	In-app mode. <code>testcrack.com/oet-preparation</code>. No <code>oetcrack.com</code>. Branded house — at six exams, per-exam domains cost six of everything and convert an in-product toggle into a fresh acquisition. Also removes the trademark exposure entirely. The ≥2-week domain lead time is deleted.
5	One dashboard with switcher, or separate apps	One dashboard, exam switcher. Picker shows only when >1 exam is active. <i>This reverses the v1 recommendation of separate apps per exam.</i>

C · Account Portability

#	Question	Answer
6	Same login across exams	Yes, unconditionally. "No" abandons unified identity, cross-exam analytics and the single competency matrix. Cost of yes: zero — <code>exam_type</code> lives on the enrollment, not the account.
7	Cross-institute student enrollment	Model it as yes, gate it as no. Schema permissive (adding it later means migrating live student rows); RBAC restrictive for v1 via one named guard function . Flip on the first real request.
8	Tutor across both exams	Yes. Tutors attach to batches; batches carry <code>exam_type</code> . No special handling.

D · OET Product Scope

#	Question	Answer
9	All 6 professions or Nursing-only	Nursing-only for v1. Largest pool, documented demand (Germany short 30–40k nurses, 16,600 Indian nurses already placed, B2 English specified). <code>ExamConfig.profession</code> makes Medicine later a content change, not a code change.
10	OET Speaking role-play in v1	No for v1; reserve the enum value now. <code>speakingFormat: 'roleplay'</code> already exists in <code>ExamConfig</code> . Ship L+R+W. By the time we want role-play, the viva engine will have taught us a great deal about oral assessment.
11	Target OET grade	Grade B (numeric ~350) across subtests — the threshold most regulators require.

E · Content Ownership

#	Question	Answer
12	Who creates the OET bank	A three-stage pipeline, gated on the verification engine: AI-generated drafts → contracted medical-English SME review → Platform Services' verification engine → validated, difficulty-tagged bank. Not in-house <i>or</i> contracted <i>or</i> licensed — all three in sequence, cheapest step first.
13	Listening audio	AI-generated for the pilot bank , with a stated exception: any item whose assessed sub-skill <i>is</i> accent comprehension or clinical register gets a human recording. Upgrade item-by-item after pilot feedback.
—	 New blocker introduced	No SME writes a single item before a written IP assignment is signed. Under Indian copyright law, commissioned works vest in the author absent written assignment — we would pay for a bank we cannot license.

F · Compliance & Legal

#	Question	Answer
1 4	OET trademark review	Stricter than v1 assumed. CBLA's published IP policy requires <i>prior express written permission</i> for any use of the OET marks. Nominative fair use is a defence, not a permission . Three hard rules: no exam name in any domain/product/app name; referential descriptive use only; never any CBLA logo or styling. Encoded in <code>ExamConfig.legalDisplayName</code> . Lawyer opinion still wanted before OET marketing copy — does not block backend work .
1 5	Preparation, not testing provider	Confirmed, and now schema-backed via <code>ExamConfig.legalDisclaimer</code> rather than relying on someone remembering.
—	⚠ New: CCPA Coaching Guidelines 2024	Applies to coaching operations serving >50 students . Prohibits false claims on selection rates, ranks, success metrics and guaranteed outcomes; requires uniform-font disclaimers alongside claims; requires written post-result consent before using any student's name, photo or testimonial. Enforced under the Consumer Protection Act 2019. Constrains the calibration claim and all of Content & Growth's outreach copy.
—	⚠ New: DPDP Rules 2025	In force 14 Nov 2025. Verifiable guardian consent for under-18s; stated purpose/retention/withdrawal in notice; breach notification; audits. Voice recordings in viva_answer are personal data with a retention obligation. Schema in TC-04 §9.

G · Timeline & Validation

#	Question	Answer
1 6	OET pilot launch date	No hard date. Per D3 the agreed objective is revenue evidence, and Spoken English answers that faster. OET is sequenced behind the content gate.

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| 1 | Confirmed OET | Open — and moot for now. Revisit once Spoken English has met the revenue-evidence bar. If a partner appears, it justifies a hard date and real content spend. |
| 7 | institute partner | |
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Part 2 — New decisions, resolved

H · New Features

#	Question	Answer
18	Viva engine v1 scope	Build once, expose to Spoken English + IELTS Speaking (option c). Forced by the exam-agnostic principle — an engine serving one exam is the anti-pattern we're removing.
19	Viva transcription	Gemini audio-in for v1. ≈\$0.004/question, ≈₹3.5 per 10-question session. Cache the rubric prompt (~10× cheaper). Add dedicated STT only when a real scoring gap is demonstrated.
20	Predictive Readiness go/no-go	Build v1 during S4 , rule-based, on data we already store. No ML infra.
21	Calibration claim public or internal	Internal-first — now a compliance requirement, not a preference. See CCPA row above. Publish only with sample size and error band disclosed.
22	Study Companion timing	Post-pilot, S4+. Retention lever, not a launch feature.

I · Track 1 — Spoken English (*now Exam 2, the priority track*)

#	Question	Answer
23	Spoken English v1 scope	Speaking-only viva , scored in CEFR, reusing existing question data and descriptors. Zero new content.

24	Pricing + target segments	Separate paid module (D2) on the existing institute subscription. Segments: Kerala English institutes and technical training centres (Luminar / Brototype type). The price <i>point</i> within that structure is a GTM test, not a schema input.
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J · Standalone API Products

#	Question	Answer
25	Free-tier branding	Confirmed — visible "Powered by TestCrack" on all free tiers, as the distribution channel.
26	Pricing model per product	Pay-per-use for evaluation APIs (Writing, Speaking — cost scales with calls, and usage-based pricing benchmarks at 115–130% NRR vs 95–105% flat); subscription for Batch Report Generator ; licensed access for Question Bank .
27	Question Bank licensing boundary	D4: questions + difficulty metadata licensable — the difficulty tagging is the differentiator and prices the tier. Performance data, competency matrix and calibration model never leave. No read path from the licensing product to the platform DB — not a replica, not an export, not a view.

K · Resourcing

#	Question	Answer
28	Resource split	Confirmed. Backend Engineering → exam-switching model + backend; Frontend Engineering → frontend/journey/viva UI; Platform Services → verification engine (now critical path) + standalone API products, concurrently, on isolated dev/infra.

What is still open

Item	Owner	Blocks
Indian IP lawyer opinion on exam-name usage	Founder	OET marketing copy only — not backend, not schema
Named OET institute partner (Q17)	Founder / Content & Growth	Nothing until the revenue-evidence bar is met

Spoken English price point within the module structure	Founder	Nothing — structure is decided, the number is a GTM test
SME IP assignment template	Founder	Stage 2 of the content pipeline. Real blocker.

The gates that replaced the old blocker

The old gate — "TC-02 answered before any OET code" — is retired. Two gates replace it:

1. **Zero IELTS regression / CI green** before any second exam registers. A red IELTS build is stop-the-line for everyone, regardless of who is online.
 2. **Verification engine ships before OET content sourcing begins.** Sourcing unverified clinical content is worse than sourcing it late — we would pay the SME cost and get an asset we can neither trust nor license.
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